



Haverhill

Economic Development and Planning
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HAYCITYCLERK

To: Haverhill City Council

From: Jacki Byerley, AICP, Planning Director

Date: August 6, 2026

Re: CCSP-26-6 – 512 Washington Street

Following review of the Special Permit application, supporting materials, and the applicable provisions of the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance, it is recommended that the City Council approve the Special Permit to allow the development of seven (7) affordable homeownership units at 512 Washington Street, subject to the conditions outlined below.

The proposal by Essex County Habitat for Humanity includes the rehabilitation of the existing structure into three affordable condominium units, demolition of the existing garage and construction of two duplex buildings, resulting in a total of seven permanently affordable homeownership opportunities.

The project advances several important planning objectives for the City. It promotes reinvestment in an established neighborhood, utilizes existing infrastructure efficiently and provides much-needed affordable homeownership opportunities for Haverhill residents.

The proposed use is also consistent with the intent of the High Density Residential (RH) District. Multifamily dwellings are permitted within the district by Special Permit provided the standards of the Zoning Ordinance are met.

Additionally, the proposal is consistent with the City's long-term planning objectives by encouraging infill development within an existing neighborhood, supporting housing production, and advancing the goals identified for targeted growth and revitalization along Washington Street.

To ensure the long-term public benefits of this development are maintained, I recommend that the Special Permit be approved with the following conditions:

1. **Permanent Affordability.** All seven residential units shall remain affordable in perpetuity in accordance with the City's affordable housing requirements and any applicable state or local affordability restrictions.

2. **Monitoring Agent.** Prior to the issuance of any occupancy permits, the applicant shall identify and establish an approved monitoring entity responsible for administering and enforcing the affordability restrictions, including monitoring future sales, purchaser eligibility, resale prices, and compliance with all affordability requirements.
3. **Condominium Documents. Condominium Association.** Prior to the sale or conveyance of any unit, the applicant shall establish a condominium association. The condominium documents shall provide for the ownership, maintenance, repair, replacement, and management of all common areas, parking areas, driveways, landscaping, utilities, stormwater facilities, and other shared improvements. The condominium documents shall also establish an adequate reserve fund for the long-term maintenance and replacement of common facilities, to be reviewed by the City Solicitor and departments prior to recording at the Registry of Deeds.
4. **Approved Plans and Architectural Design.** The Applicant, property owner, and their successors or assigns (collectively, the "Applicant") shall construct the project substantially in accordance with the plans, architectural renderings, and elevations submitted with the Special Permit application, which are incorporated herein by reference. If the Applicant determines that any modification to the approved plans is necessary, the Applicant shall submit the proposed modification in writing to the Building Commissioner and obtain the required approval prior to implementing the modification.

The Building Commissioner shall make a determination of whether a proposed modification is minor or major. Minor changes may be approved in writing by the Building Commissioner after consultation with the Planning Director and Director of Inspectional Services. Any modification determined by the Building Commissioner to be major shall require review and approval by the City Council following a public hearing.

5. A Development Review meeting for review of the plans for compliance with City regulations and applicable state laws shall take place prior to start of construction.
6. A landscaping plan shall be reviewed by the Planning Director prior to planting and must be planted prior to occupancy or at the next planting season. The association shall maintain the landscaping throughout the life of the project, should any of the landscaping die it shall be replaced during the next available planting season

It is recommended that the City Council approve the requested Special Permit, subject to the suggested conditions, standard special permit conditions and recommendation made by the departments.